Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Cleaning & Hygiene

1. Purpose

To establish a systematic cleaning and hygiene procedure to maintain a clean working environment, improve product quality, ensure safe working conditions, and comply with applicable statutory requirements.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to the production area, raw material storage, finished goods storage, packing & dispatch area, office, washrooms, and all employees working in the factory

3. Responsibilities

- **Management:**
  - Provide the necessary resources, cleaning materials, tools, and training for effective cleaning and hygiene practices.
  - Conduct periodic inspections and internal audits to ensure compliance with the company's cleaning procedures.
- **Production Incharge :**
  - Supervise daily cleaning activities and ensure the cleaning schedule is followed.
  - Verify that cleaning activities are completed as per company procedures.
  - Report any cleaning or housekeeping issues to the Factory Manager.
- **Employees:**
  - Carry out cleaning activities as per the prescribed procedures.
  - Maintain personal hygiene while working.
  - Report any housekeeping or hygiene-related issues immediately.

- **4. Cleaning and Hygiene Procedures**

4.1 Area-Specific Cleaning

- **Production Areas:**
  - Clean work tables, machines, tools, and surrounding areas before starting work and after production.
  - Use suitable cleaning materials for cleaning floors, machines, and work areas.
  - Remove dust, flower residue, charcoal powder, and other production waste after completion of work

- **Storage Areas:**
  - Keep storage areas clean and free from dust, moisture, and pest infestation.
  - Maintain proper ventilation and keep the storage area dry and well organised.
  - Store raw materials and finished products neatly on racks or pallets.

- **Packaging Areas:**
  - Clean packing tables, weighing scales, sealing machines, and other packing equipment before and after use.
  - Keep packing materials protected from dust and moisture.
  - Maintain cleanliness throughout the packing and dispatch area.
- **Common Areas:**
  - Clean floors, walls, windows, washrooms, and frequently touched surfaces regularly.
  - Ensure office and common areas remain neat and clean at all times.

- **4.2 Equipment Cleaning**
  - Clean machines and equipment after completion of production.
  - Use a dry cloth, brush, or damp cloth as required for cleaning.
  - Remove dust, residue, and waste materials from equipment before storage.
  - Record equipment cleaning activities in the maintenance register.

- **4.3 Personal Hygiene**
  - Employees shall wear clean uniforms or aprons and use gloves or masks whenever required.
  - Hands shall be washed before starting work and after using the washroom.
  - Eating, drinking, and smoking are strictly prohibited inside the production and storage areas.
  - Employees shall maintain personal cleanliness throughout working hours.

- **4.4 Cleaning Agents and Tools**
  - Use suitable cleaning materials and tools appropriate for the work area.
  - Cleaning materials shall be stored safely in a designated place after use.
  - Cleaning tools shall be kept clean and replaced whenever damaged.

5. Regulatory Compliance

- Comply with applicable statutory requirements and company procedures.
- Conduct regular internal inspections to ensure cleaning and hygiene practices are properly followed.

6. Customer Requirements

- Maintain product quality through proper housekeeping and cleanliness.
- Respond to customer complaints related to cleanliness, if any.
- Take corrective action whenever required and maintain records..

7. Documentation

- Maintain cleaning records for all work areas and equipment.
- Record inspection findings and observations.
- Record corrective actions taken for any non-conformities.
- Maintain employee training records related to cleaning and hygiene.

8. Training

- Conduct regular training programmes on cleaning procedures, housekeeping practices, workplace safety, and personal hygiene.
- Evaluate employee understanding through observations and practical guidance.

9. Monitoring and Auditing

- The Factory Manager shall inspect cleaning activities regularly to ensure compliance.
- Internal audits shall be conducted quarterly to identify areas for improvement.
- Management shall review the effectiveness of cleaning activities during internal inspections and implement corrective actions wherever required.

Prepared By:

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